Lab 12 — External References and PDF Import

WSQ Technical Drawing with AutoCAD (TGS-2021005538) · Topic 04: Organizing Objects

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Objective

LO4 — assemble drawings from shared reference content (A4, K4)

Goal

Attach the title-block drawing as an external reference under the table drawing, observe how xref updates flow through, then attach a PDF as an underlay and import PDF geometry.

You'll produce

A host drawing with a live xref title block and a PDF underlay ready for tracing.

Commands / tools: XREF/ATTACH, External References palette, PDFATTACH, PDFIMPORT

Files in this lab

- title-block.dwg
- ex1-drawing-sheet.pdf
- new-office-layout-with-xref.dwg

Step-by-step

1. Open your layered table drawing from Lab 9 as the host drawing

   ```
   OPEN table-layers.dwg
   ```

2. Attach title-block.dwg as an Xref at 0,0, scale 1

   ```
   XATTACH → title-block.dwg
   ```

3. Open the External References palette and note the xref's status and path

   ```
   XR (External References)
   ```

4. Edit the title block in its own file, save, and reload the xref in the host

   ```
   XR → right-click → Reload
   ```

5. Attach the supplied drawing-sheet PDF as an underlay and snap to its geometry

   ```
   PDFATTACH → ex1-drawing-sheet.pdf
   ```

6. Import the PDF's vector geometry into the drawing and inspect the created objects

   ```
   PDFIMPORT → select underlay area
   ```

Check your work

Changing the title block file and reloading updates the host without copying geometry, and PDFIMPORT produces editable AutoCAD objects from the underlay.

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